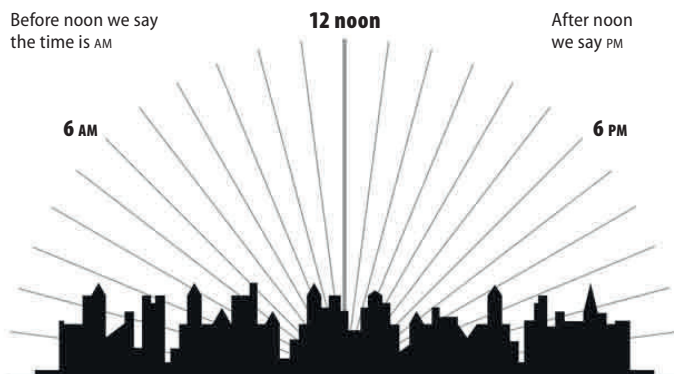


Analogue time

Most clocks and watches only go up to 12 hours, but there are 24 hours in one day. To show the difference between morning and night, we use AM or PM. The middle of the day (12 o'clock) is called midday or noon.



△ AM or PM

The initials AM and PM stand for the Latin words **ante meridiem** (meaning "before noon") and **post meridiem** (meaning "after noon"). The first 12 hours of the day are called AM and the second 12 hours of the day are called PM.

Digital time

Traditional clock faces show time in an analogue format but digital formats are also common, especially on electrical devices such as computers, televisions, and mobile phones. Some digital displays show time in the 24-hour system; others use the analogue system and also show AM or PM.



△ Hours and minutes

On a digital clock, the hours are shown first followed by a colon and the minutes. Some displays may also show seconds.



△ 24-hour digital display

If the hours or minutes are single digit numbers, a zero (called a leading zero) is placed to the left of the digit.



△ Midnight

When it is midnight, the clock resets to 00:00. Midnight is an abbreviated form of "middle of the night."



△ 12-hour digital display

This type of display will have AM and PM with the relevant part of the day highlighted.

24-hour clock

The 24-hour system was devised to stop confusion between morning and afternoon times, and runs continuously from midnight to midnight. It is often used in computers, by the military, and on timetables. To convert from the 12-hour system to the 24-hour system, you add 12 to the hour for times after noon. For example, 11 PM becomes 23:00 ($11 + 12$) and 8:45 PM becomes 20:45 ($8:45 + 12$).

12-hour clock	24-hour clock
12:00 midnight	00:00
1:00 AM	01:00
2:00 AM	02:00
3:00 AM	03:00
4:00 AM	04:00
5:00 AM	05:00
6:00 AM	06:00
7:00 AM	07:00
8:00 AM	08:00
9:00 AM	09:00
10:00 AM	10:00
11:00 AM	11:00
12:00 noon	12:00
1:00 PM	13:00
2:00 PM	14:00
3:00 PM	15:00
4:00 PM	16:00
5:00 PM	17:00
6:00 PM	18:00
7:00 PM	19:00
8:00 PM	20:00
9:00 PM	21:00
10:00 PM	22:00
11:00 PM	23:00